ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

Karaikudi - 630003, Tamil Nadu, India.

DEPARTMENT OF NUTRITION AND DIETETICS

and

THE NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF FOOD TECHNOLOGY, ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND MANAGEMENT, THANJAVUR

Jointly organize

National Symposium on "PROMOTING NUTRITIONAL DIETS THROUGH MILLETS"

Date: 12.04.2024 (Friday) Time: 10.00 AM | Venue : Conference Hall, 4th Floor, Science Campus

ABOUT THE UNIVERSITY

Alagappa University emerged from a group of institutions founded in the 1950`s by Padma Bhushan Dr. RM. Alagappa Chettiar (06.04.1909 - 05.04.1957). It is a State Government University established by an Act of the Tamil Nadu State Legislature in 1985 as a Unitary type, later becoming an Affiliating type in 2002. The University is located in Karaikudi, in the District of Sivaganga, Tamil Nadu, on a 420-acre lush green campus. Alagappa University was established by a Special Act of the Government of Tamil Nadu in May 1985 with the objective of fostering research, development, and dissemination of knowledge in various branches of learning. It is recognized by the University Grants Commission (UGC) of India and has 45 departments, 3 academic centres, and 2 constituent colleges (AUCE, AUCPE) on its campus. Additionally, 45 colleges in the districts of Sivaganga and Ramanathapuram are affiliated with the University. The University offers UG & PG programmes in the four faculties (Arts, Science, Education, Management) through regular, distance, online, and collaborative modes of education, catering to around 1.12 lakh students. As a member of the Association of Indian Universities (AIU) and the Association of Commonwealth Universities (ACU), it has strong relations with other academic institutions, research laboratories, and industrial establishments. The University also has international collaborations with universities and institutions of higher learning in countries such as the U.S.A, UK, Australia, Singapore, China, Malaysia, and South Korea. The University's motto is "Excellence in Action," and it aims for excellence in all spheres of its action.

Alagappa University has achieved many milestones. A few of them are as under;

- 1985: Establishment of Alagappa University as Unitary type.
- 1992: Establishment of Directorate of Distance Education (DDE).
- 2002: Converted as Affiliating University.
- 2005: Secured "A" Grade by NAAC Accreditation (1st Cycle).
- 2011: Secured "A" Grade by NAAC Accreditation (2nd Cycle).
- 2017: Secured "A+"Grade by NAAC Accreditation (3rd Cycle) with a CGPA of 3.64.
- 2018: Obtained Category–I status by the MHRD-UGC.
- 2018: Establishment of Directorate of Online Programmes.
- 2018: Secured 4th position in Swachhta Ranking for the cleanest HEI in the Country in the category of Government Institutions.
- 2018: Secured MHRD - RUSA 2.0 Scheme with a grant of Rs.100 crores for Quality enhancement.

Department of Nutrition and Dietetics Profile

The Department was established in the year 2023. The Department offers a two year M.Sc., Degree Programme in Nutrition and Dietetics from the Academic year 2023 - 2024. Our work focuses towards nurturing the students in solving the nutritional issues and setbacks faced by the community to forge a society with fitness and finesse. The postgraduate programme in Nutrition and Dietetics includes the complete study of basic components of foods; their nutrients chemistry and metabolism; technology involved in food processing and preservation; food safety; functional food, meal planning, quantity food production and therapeutic dietary modifications with a focus on human health and well-being. Nutrition is the foundation for good health that is a vital component of national development. The department is making concerted efforts to achieve the national goal of "Healthy diet going affordable to all" through its continuous societal outreach activities in the rural areas serving the women and children, there by realizing the vision of our esteemed organization. Since its inception, the department has directed its activities towards development of the community to shape the prospective academicians, administrators, researchers, entrepreneurs and health conscious citizens.

About the NIFTEM-T

National Institute of Food Technology, Entrepreneurship and Management, Thanjavur (NIFTEM-T) is an academic institution with Institute of National Importance (INI) status, functioning under the Ministry of Food Processing Industries, Government of India. NIFTEM-T offers the following academic programmes: Undergraduate programme B.Tech (Food Technology), Post Graduate programmes M.Tech (Food Technology) in Food Process Technology, M.Tech (Food Technology) in Food Process Engineering, M.Tech (Food Technology) in Food Safety and Quality Assurance, Research programmes Ph.D (Food Technology) in Food Process Technology and Ph.D (Food Technology) in Food Process Engineering. NIFTEM-T has been ranked 13th in Agriculture and Allied Sector Category & among 101-150 in Engineering Colleges category by the NIRF Ranking of Ministry of Education.

Further, NIFTEM-T has established the Centre for Excellence in Grain Science (CEGS) and Centre of Excellence in Non-Thermal Processing (CENTP). CEGS focuses primarily on establishing protocols to standardize various quality testing parameters for nutrient analysis and assessing the quality of grain varieties. This facility also offers services for quality evaluation and milling of millets and pulses, as well as processing oilseeds. Collaborating with key industry partners, the CEGS aims to educate students and professionals engaged in grain milling, conduct ground-breaking research, and offer solutions to challenges encountered by the milling sector. In parallel, the CENTP emphasizes food processing without heat application, preserving taste, appearance, and nutrition. It boasts unique equipment for methods like cold plasma processing and ultraviolet treatment, with plans to expand its capabilities further.

Recognizing the importance of food safety and quality, the NIFTEM-T has established Food Testing and Quality Testing Laboratory. NIFTEM-T has a world class hi-tech food testing laboratory accredited by National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories under ISO/IEC 17025:2017. Further NIFTEM-T Food Testing Lab has been recognized as FSSAI referral and reference lab. Food Analysis Laboratory has been equipped with modern equipments to carryout physico-chemical analysis of food, water and any organic samples. This laboratory has hi-tech analytical instruments like GCMS, ICPMS, LCMS, NMR, HPLC, HPTLC Amino acid analyzer, Iron chromatography for analyzing biochemical parameters, pesticides residual and nutrition etc. in samples related to food products.

Further, to encourage the engagement of new entrepreneurs in the food processing and value addition industry, NIFTEM-T offers hands-on training via extensive technical programs. These initiatives equip aspiring entrepreneurs with the essential skills and knowledge required to effectively manage the intricacies of food processing. Additionally, NIFTEM-T grants entrepreneurs access to its incubation facilities, allowing them to conduct market trials and collect valuable feedback. Equipped with state-of-the-art technology and resources, this facility caters to the varied needs of budding entrepreneurs, providing them with an ideal environment to develop their ideas and translate them into thriving enterprises.

About Symposium

Millets are easy to cultivate, are mostly organic, and contain high nutritional value and hence considered as 'Smart Food'. Cultivated in more than 130 countries at present, millets are the traditional food for more than half a billion people across Asia and Africa. In India, millets are primarily a Kharif crop, requiring less water and agricultural inputs in comparison to other similar staples. Millets are dual purpose crops and are cultivated both as food and fodder, thus providing food/livelihood security to millions of households and contributing to the economic efficiency of farming. Millets contribute to mitigating climate change as they consume less water and have a low carbon footprint.

On the well-being front, Millet grain is abundant in nutrients and health-beneficial phenolic compounds, making it suitable as food and feed. The diverse content of nutrients and phenolic compounds present in finger and pearl millet are good indicators that the variety of millet available is important when selecting it for use as food or feed. In view of their potential role in achieving food security, the United Nations in 2021, on the proposal of the Indian Prime Minister, Mr. Narendra Modi, and supported by 71 countries, declared 2023 the International Year of Millets (IYM 2023) with the FAO as the lead agency.

The National Symposium On "Promoting Nutritional diets through Millets" (PNDM-2024) being organized by Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University, Karaikudi on 12th April 2024, will offer a forum to create mass awareness on the diversity of millets, their invaluable nutritional properties, environmental benefits, to discuss the nutritional importance of millets for health benefits, and to plan and recommend strategies to enhance the millet health awareness.

Scientific Topics

- Role of food and beverage fraternity in promotion of millets.
- Nutrients and Nutraceuticals: Millet nutrients, Millet food, Millet healing effects, millet health benefits, millet nutraceuticals, etc.
- Role of millets in adaptation to climate change
- Genetically modification of Foods.

Programme Committee

Chief Patrons

Sr. Prof. G. Ravi
Vice-Chancellor, Alagappa University
Karaikudi.

Prof. V. Palanimuthu
Director, NIFTEM-T.

Co-Patrons

Prof. A. Senthilrajan
Registrar, Alagappa University
Karaikudi.

Dr. S. Shanmugasundaram
Registrar (i/c), NIFTEM-T.

Organizing Secretaries

Dr. P. Rameshthangam
Associate Professor and Head (i/c)
Department of Nutrition and Dietetics
Alagappa University

Dr. N. Venkatachalapathy,
Dean (Research, Consultancy & International Relations). NIFTEM-T.

Invited Speakers

Dr. R. Jagan Mohan
Professor and Head, Dept. of Food Product Development, National Institute of Food Technology, Entrepreneurship and Management, Thanjavur (NIFTEM-T).

Dr. Arunkumar Panneerselvam
Principal Scientist, Department of Food Packaging Technology, CSIR – Central Food Technological Research Institute Mysuru, Karnataka

Dr. Vincent Hema
Associate Professor, Department of Food Processing Business Incubation Centre, NIFTEM-T.

Dr. S. Shajahan
Scientist, Department of Nutrition & Bioscience, Tata chemicals Ltd, Innovation centre, Andhra Pradesh.

Dr. N. Kumaresan
Scientist, Research and Development Laboratory, Britannia Industries Ltd., Bidadi, Bangalore.

Registration

The registration fee can be transferred to the Indian Bank SB account (7747495255) or UPI ID / QR Code. Please ensure that proof of payment is attached during the registration process.

Participants	Registration (Rs.)
PG Students	300/-
Research Scholars	500/-
Faculties/Scientists	1000/-

UPI ID: nutritionaldiet@indianbk

Scan to Pay

Scan to Register

Registration link: https://forms.gle/GZk5GpNf1b1aWkHP8

Address for Communication

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